

Part



GRAMMAR SESSION 8 • 11TH AUGUST • FINAL SESSION

Part
Writes

Figures of Speech

The Art of Saying More Than You Say

Class 8 – 10 | SSC & CBSE

DECENT COACHING CLASSES

What We'll Cover

literal
U2 W



What Is a Figure of Speech?

Non-literal language used for a greater effect



4 Categories

Resemblance Contrast Association Construction



17 Core Figures

The full syllabus list



Bonus Figures

Extra figures for deeper Class 9–10 CBSE study



Master Tables

Quick-reference revision anchors



PYQ Practice

Exam-style questions across Class 8–10

Our Grammar Journey So Far



Session 1

Parts of Speech, Subject-Verb Agreement, Question Tags, Prepositions



Session 2

Tenses — Present / Past / Future in all their forms



Session 3

Active & Passive Voice



Session 4

Reported Speech — Direct vs Indirect



Session 5

Modals, Determiners, Articles & Non-Finite Verbs

What Is a Figure of Speech?

Camel is
ship of desert

A Figure of Speech is a departure from the ordinary form of expression, or the ordinary course of ideas, in order to produce a greater effect.

In simple words: it is a word or phrase used in a NON-LITERAL sense — saying one thing in terms of something else — for rhetorical or vivid effect.

literal (adj.): taking words in their usual, most basic sense, without exaggeration. rhetoric (n.): the art of effective or persuasive speaking/writing.

 **Just for fun:** When Mom says "it's raining cats and dogs," she doesn't mean animals are falling from the sky — she means it's raining VERY heavily!

4 Categories of Figures of Speech



Resemblance

Simile, Metaphor, Personification, Apostrophe



Contrast

Antithesis, Oxymoron, Epigram



Association

Metonymy, Synecdoche, Transferred Epithet



Construction

Climax, Anticlimax

This lens groups the figures by HOW they work — comparing (resemblance), opposing (contrast), linking (association), or ordering (construction) ideas.

Simile

Simile: A direct comparison between two different things, usually joined by "like", "as", or "so" — the objects are of different kinds but share one point in common.

As brave as a lion.

Her smile was like sunshine.

As the hart panteth after the water-brooks, so panteth my soul after Thee, O God.



Just for fun: My dog is as smelly as dirty socks — a simile can be silly AND vivid at the same time!

Metaphor

indirect

~~as... as~~
~~like~~

Metaphor: An IMPLIED simile — it does not say one thing is "like" another, but takes it for granted and speaks as if the two things were literally one.

The camel is a ship of the desert.

Time is money.

The world is a stage.

M of V

Every simile can be compressed into a metaphor, and every metaphor can be expanded into a simile: "Akash fought like a lion" (simile) → "Akash was a lion in the fight" (metaphor).

Personification

Personification: Giving human qualities, feelings, or actions to non-living things, animals, or abstract ideas — as if they were alive and could think or feel.

The wind whispered through the trees.

The trees screamed in the raging wind.

anger



Just for fun: Can trees actually scream? No — but "screaming" paints a much more powerful picture of a wild, stormy wind than plain words would!

Apostrophe

Apostrophe: A direct address to the dead, to someone absent, or to a non-living/abstract thing as if it were alive and could hear you. It is a special form of Personification.

O Death, where is thy sting?

"Oh! Stars and clouds and winds, ye are all about to mock me..." — Mary Shelley, Frankenstein (1818)

 **Just for fun:** Ever talked to your phone when it wouldn't charge, or begged your alarm clock for "5 more minutes"? That's an apostrophe in everyday life!

Alliteration & Onomatopoeia

Ref

ALLITERATION

Repetition of the same consonant SOUND at the beginning of two or more nearby words.

e.g. She sells sea shells on the sea shore.
S s s s s s s s s s

ONOMATOPOEIA

A word whose sound imitates the sound of the thing it describes.

e.g. The bees buzz. *e.g. The bells jingle.* *e.g. cuckoo, sizzle, crash*

ba dum tsh



Just for fun: Try saying "she sells sea shells" five times fast — that repeated "s" sound tripping up your tongue IS the alliteration at work!

Hyperbole & Litotes

HYPERBOLE

A statement made emphatic by deliberate OVERSTATEMENT — not meant to be taken literally.

exaggeration

e.g. I've told you a million times. e.g. I will literally die if you don't stop!

LITOTES (BONUS — CLASS 9-10)

The opposite of hyperbole: an affirmative is expressed by NEGATING its opposite, making a strong point using weaker words.

e.g. The man is no fool. (= very clever) e.g. "There isn't anything I won't eat when I'm hungry" (= I'll eat anything)



Just for fun: Hyperbole shouts "A MILLION TIMES!" while litotes quietly says "not exactly a fool" — both make the same strong point, in opposite ways.

Euphemism (Bonus — Class 9-10)

Euphemism: Describing a disagreeable or unpleasant thing using an agreeable, milder name — softening the blow of hard truths.

You are telling me a fairy tale. (i.e. a lie)

"I'm going to be spending more time with the family" (i.e. I was fired)

"He passed away" (i.e. he died)



Just for fun: Euphemisms are how grown-ups say hard things gently — "let go" instead of "fired," "passed away" instead of "died."

Oxymoron

Oxymoron: A special form of Antithesis in which two CONTRADICTORY or opposite terms are combined together in the same phrase.

Deafening silence.

Sweet sorrow.

Known secret.

Pretty ugly.

Awfully nice.

Antithesis

Antithesis: A striking opposition or contrast of words or ideas placed together in the same sentence, used to secure emphasis.

Speech is silver, but silence is golden.

Love and hate. Good and evil. Peace and war.



Just for fun: Notice Oxymoron squeezes the contrast into ONE phrase ("sweet sorrow"), while Antithesis spreads it across a whole sentence.

Epigram (Bonus — Class 9–10)

Epigram: A brief, pointed saying that frequently introduces antithetical (contrasting) ideas to excite surprise and arrest attention.

"Mankind must put an end to war, or war will put an end to mankind." — John F. Kennedy

"Live simply, so that others may simply live." — Mother Teresa

Irony

Irony: A mode of speech in which the real meaning is exactly the OPPOSITE of what is literally said.

A fire station burns down.

"For Brutus is an honourable man; so are they all, all honourable men." — Marc Antony (Julius Caesar) actually means the opposite — Brutus is NOT honourable.

Arjun

Pun

→ homonyms

Pun: The use of a word in such a way that it can be understood in more than one sense — used for a witty or humorous effect.

Is life worth living? — It depends upon the liver. (liver = the organ, or "one who lives")

A bicycle can't stand on its own because it is two-tyred. (too tired)



Just for fun: Puns are the reason your teacher groans at "Dad jokes" — they're bad AND clever at the exact same time!

Paraprosdokian (Bonus — Class 9–10)

Paraprosdokian: A sentence or phrase where the LATTER part causes you to rethink or reinterpret the earlier part — a favourite trick of comedians.

"If I could just say a few words, I'd be a better public speaker." — Homer Simpson

"Your argument is sound. Just sound. Lots of sound."

Metonymy & Synecdoche (Bonus — Class 9–10)

METONYMY

An object is called by the name of something else closely ASSOCIATED with it (literally: "a change of name").

e.g. The Crown (for the King/monarchy)

SYNECDOCHE

A PART is used to represent the whole, or the whole is used to represent a part.

e.g. Give us this day our daily bread. (bread = food in general) e.g. England won the test match. (England = the English cricket team)



Just for fun: Metonymy swaps in a related THING ("the Crown"); Synecdoche swaps in a PART or the WHOLE of the same thing ("bread" for all food).

Transferred Epithet

Transferred Epithet: An epithet (a descriptive word or phrase) that logically belongs to one noun is transferred to another, closely associated noun in the sentence.

He spent a sleepless night. (it's HE who doesn't sleep, not the "night")

An unbreakfasted morning.

"It was a fun day." (the experience was fun, not literally the "day")

Climax & Anticlimax (Bonus — Class 9–10)

CLIMAX

The arrangement of a series of ideas in order of INCREASING importance.

e.g. He lost his wealth, his health, and finally his life. *e.g. "There are three things that will endure: faith, hope, and love. But the greatest of these is love."*

ANTICLIMAX

The opposite of Climax — a sudden descent from higher to lower, chiefly used for satire or ridicule.

e.g. He lost his family, his car, and his cell phone.



Just for fun: Climax builds UP to something big ("...and finally his life!"); Anticlimax builds up, then comically drops ("...and his cell phone." — oops!).

Anaphora (Repetition) & Rhetorical Question

ANAPHORA / REPETITION

Deliberate repetition of a word or phrase at the beginning of successive clauses, for emphasis.

e.g. Every day, every night, in every way, I am getting better.

RHETORICAL QUESTION (INTERROGATION)

A question asked not to get an answer, but to make a point more forcefully than a plain statement could.

e.g. Isn't it obvious what we must do? e.g. Aren't you ashamed of yourself?

Inversion (Anastrophe)

Inversion: Reversing the normal subject-verb word order of a sentence for emphasis or poetic effect.

Never have I seen such courage.

"Persuade you, I shall." — Yoda



Just for fun: Yoda from Star Wars speaks almost entirely in inversion — that's exactly why he sounds so wise and unusual!

Exclamation



Exclamation: The exclamatory sentence form is used to draw far greater attention to a point than a plain, matter-of-fact statement ever could.

What a wonderful day it is!

How sweet the moonlight sleeps upon this bank!

Master Table — Core Figures (Std X SSC)

Simile	Direct comparison using like/as/so → brave as a lion
Metaphor	Implied comparison, no like/as → Time is money
Personification	Human traits given to non-living things → the wind whispered
Apostrophe	Addressing the dead/absent/abstract → O Death, where is thy sting?
Alliteration	Same consonant sound repeated → she sells sea shells
Onomatopoeia	Word imitates a sound → buzz, jingle
Hyperbole	Deliberate overstatement → told you a million times
Oxymoron	Two contradictory terms together → deafening silence

Master Table — Core Figures (Std X SSC), Contd.

Irony	Real meaning is opposite of literal words → fire station burns down
Pun	Word used in 2 senses for wit → depends on the liver
Antithesis	Opposite ideas balanced in one sentence → speech is silver, silence golden
Climax	Ideas arranged in increasing importance → lost wealth, health, life
Anaphora / Repetition	Same phrase repeated at clause starts → every day, every night...
Rhetorical Question	Question asked for effect, no answer expected → isn't it obvious?
Inversion	Reversed subject-verb order → Never have I seen such courage
Transferred Epithet	Adjective moved to a nearby noun → a sleepless night
Exclamation	Exclamatory form for strong emotion → What a wonderful day!

Master Table — Bonus Figures (Class 9–10)

Litotes	Understatement using negation → the man is no fool
Euphemism	Softer name for an unpleasant thing → passed away (died)
Epigram	Brief, pointed, contrasting saying → speech is silver, silence golden (style)
Paraprosdokian	Ending flips meaning of the start → "I'd be a better public speaker"
Metonymy	Object named for something associated → the Crown (= king)
Synecdoche	Part stands for whole (or vice versa) → daily bread (= food)
Anticlimax	Sudden drop after a build-up, for satire → lost his car and his cell phone

PYQ Practice (1–3)

Q1

Class 8 SB

Identify the figure of speech: "The stars danced in the night sky."

Personification

Q2

Class 8 CBSE

Identify the figure of speech: "She is as busy as a bee."

Simile

Q3

Class 9 CBSE

Name the figure of speech and explain: "The camel is the ship of the desert."

Metaphor

PYQ Practice (4–6)

Q4

Class 10 SB

Identify the figure of speech: "He lost his money, his friends, and finally his self-respect."

Climax

Q5

Class 8 SB

Identify the figure of speech: "Deafening silence filled the room after the announcement."

Oxymoron

Q6

Class 9 CBSE

Identify and justify: "Isn't it clear that hard work always pays off?"

Rhetorical

PYQ Practice (7–9)

Q7

Class 10 SB

Identify the figure of speech: "He spent a sleepless night before the exam."

Transferred Epithet

Q8

Class 8 CBSE

Create your own example of Personification and identify why it is one.

Board is shining like sun

Q9

Class 9 CBSE

Identify the figure of speech: "Speech is silver, but silence is golden."

Antithesis

Today's Recap



Resemblance

Simile, Metaphor, Personification, Apostrophe — comparing things



Contrast

Oxymoron, Antithesis, Epigram — opposing ideas together



Association

Metonymy, Synecdoche, Transferred Epithet — linked meanings



Construction

Climax, Anticlimax, Inversion — ordering ideas for effect



Congratulations!

You've completed the full Grammar course — from Parts of Speech to Figures of Speech.

Keep practising the worksheet & revising every Master Table — your English is ready to shine!